

001".

- When a role is pushed into next fiscal year, the GHPID won't change
- When a role is re-allocated into a different department, the GHPID won't change
- Each GHPID is unique to each opening of a requisition
- Department internal ID is from Netsuite as SSOT and consistent to Adaptive department code
- Once a number has been used in Greenhouse for a job, it can not be reused. If the role is a future role and has been deleted, but was never input into Greenhouse, the FBP can use that number for its replacement or a different role since it was not used yet.

Maintaining Hiring Plan

FP&A team is the owner and maintainer of SSOT for GitLab's Hiring Plan

1. Objective of this control is to ensure completeness, accuracy, and consistency of Hiring Plan

- Completeness: all approved positions are assigned with PIDs and GHPIDs
- Accuracy: no PID and GHPID is assigned to duplicated or deprecated positions
- Consistency: ensure Hiring Plan in Adaptive is fully reconciled to details in Live

Interlock Google Sheet and details in Greenhouse requisition

1. PIDs and GHPIDs are stored in Workday Adaptive (Adaptive) and are required fields in Hiring Plan

- FBPs will update Hiring Plan weekly in Adaptive & update TA through weekly Interlock.
- FBPs may update their Headcount Forecast on a more frequent basis (more than weekly) depending on their individual department's business needs
- Updating Hiring Plan could require adding new roles, deleting roles, trading off roles, or adding backfills

1. Hiring Plan audit and reconciliation is performed by Corporate, including

- Weekly GHPID audit and reconciliation through TA and FP&A Interlock
- Monthly PID audit and reconciliation through monthly forecast lock
- Corporate will reach out to FBPs if noticing any discrepancies and resolve them before monthly forecast lock

Finance Business Partners / Talent Acquisition Managers Forecast Interlock

Purpose

The FP&A team and Talent Acquisition Managers collaborate to ensure understanding and implementation of the most up-to-date view of forecasted headcount-related expenses. This interlock enables GitLab to respond quickly and make live decisions through a weekly P&L forecast and the rolling list of asks (RLOA) process. This process also ensures alignment and accuracy of headcount forecasts when FP&A locks its annual plan and monthly rolling forecasts. This process also tracks company metrics against Wall Street expectations related to non-GAAP operating income and non-GAAP earnings per share. Please see the Headcount Metrics and Processes page for definitions and key metrics.

Headcount Live Dashboards

The Hiring Plan data is divided into four headcount forecast templates, one for each cost center with Cost of Goods Sold allocated among Sales and R&D. The data and analysis from the four templates roll into the Summary file. The four templates can be found in the Headcount

Live Summary Dashboard.

Cadence / Process

Unless otherwise noted in the HC Forecast calendar or communicated via Slack, the interlock process occurs weekly as follows:

1. By noon (PST) Monday, the Corp FP&A team downloads the data from Adaptive and refreshes the headcount forecast templates. Talent Acquisition also refreshes the headcount forecast templates with the latest data from Greenhouse.

1. By end of day (PST) Wednesday, the Talent Acquisition Managers and Recruiters review their respective roles line by line and make adjustments and comments related to expected start dates and other role details provided by the Finance Business Partners. If no indication is made for a specific role in the headcount forecast template, Talent Acquisition signals that the current indication is reasonable and indicative of a 50/50 "most-realistic" forecast. The Talent Acquisition Managers also pay close attention to any recruiting capacity restraints within any given quarter. In order to maximize transparency and understanding of any changes, the Talent Acquisition Managers and Recruiters provide comments (e.g., wrong GHP ID, rejection of an offer, delay due to business decision, etc.) for specific roles.

1. By end of day (PST) Thursday, the Finance Business Partners update Adaptive with their best estimates of the start dates of all planned personnel for the forecast period based on the input from Talent Acquisition in the headcount forecast templates. This reflects a 50/50 "most realistic" view of headcount expenses/timing.

1. By end of day (PST) Friday, the Corp FP&A team sends a P&L snapshot to the CFO incorporating any headcount forecast adjustments. Note: P&L snapshots are not provided during accounting close.

Communication

Communication related to the interlock takes place in the fpa-ta-headcount-forecast Slack channel. All parties involved in the interlock are also granted access to the "HC Forecast" Google Calendar.

Deliverables

The Finance Business Partners and Talent Acquisition Managers collaborate to provide the most current and 50/50 "most-realistic" view of headcount-related expenses. This is done through the interlock process in the headcount forecast template and is ultimately uploaded into the Planned Personnel sheet in Adaptive.

The inputs loaded into Adaptive are then used to provide the CFO a weekly P&L snapshot in order to facilitate in-quarter spending decisions and ensure the company tracks vs. guidance and consensus expectations.

Adaptive Planning

A manual on how to update and maintain Adaptive integration can be found here. This document is maintained by the Corporate FP&A team.

Adaptive Quarterly Roadmap

- The current Adaptive roadmap can be found here
- We expect to transition roadmap and requests into GitLab issues by Q2-FY23.
- Corporate FP&A will host Adaptive intake sessions with the larger FP&A team to intake, align and prioritize current and future projects.

Rolling List of Asks (RLOA)

Intent of RLOA Process

1. Reinvest back into the business when company expects to beat expectations
1. Enable e-group and leaders to make informed and fast business decisions
1. Create a repeatable and transparent quarterly process into incremental investments

Expectations for Business Partners

1. Your FP&A partner will assist in maintaining a rolling list of asks (RLOA). This list includes prioritization/sequencing, rationale/ROI, and considerations against current FvP
1. In weeks 0-2 of each qtr (quarterly fcst), work with FP&A to make a final proposal, if needed, for additional investment over the rest of the fiscal year
1. By week 4 of each qtr (earnings guidance), funding decisions reviewed, prioritized, and decided by CFO and e-group

Detailed Expectations for FP&A

1. Throughout quarter, FP&A maintains alignment with business needs.
 - FBPs, with the functional leader(s), maintain a RLOA file of key incremental investments from the business
 - FBPs, with the functional leader(s), prioritize the RLOA and develop a recommendation following the below timeline
1. During quarterly RLOA process, FP&A team finalizes RLOA proposal to share with e-group, and communicates decisions to functional leaders to enable business execution. Below is the timeline
 - WD-1: Corporate FP&A locks Prelim Forecast version and shares detailed daily calendar with FBPs
 - WD+1: FBPs prepare prelim variance package and review with BPs (Async) to help the business prioritize the asks
 - Acct Close +2: Forecast pencils down
 - Corporate FP&A and VP of Finance review Forecast prior to Final Forecast Lock
 - Corporate FP&A provide Prelim Forecast vs. Final Forecast view to FBPs
 - Acct Close +3: Final Forecast Lock, used for guidance, tax, etc.
 - 3 days prior to CFO Variance Review: FBPs finalize prioritized RLOA list and submit to Corporate FP&A
 - 2 days prior to CFO Variance Review: Corporate FPA creates a brief RLOA section (~2-3 slides) to include in CFO Variance Review package. RLOA section should include:
 - P&L from Final Forecast Lock and RLOA summary

- Comparison of the functional expenses as a % of revenue after RLOA vs plan, guidance, and consensus
- Comparison of headcount requests against recruiting capacity
- Rationale for each request and Finance POV
- At CFO Variance Meeting (typically third Thu): FP&A team reviews RLOA proposal with CFO & VP of Finance. Discussion around:
 - Incremental investments required from RLOA proposal
 - Make recommendation to e-group thereafter
- At e-group Review Meeting (typically Mon after CFO Variance Meeting), CFO shares proposal for formal approval and inclusion into investor guidance
- After e-group Review Meeting, FP&A team communicates approved incremental investments to functional leaders to begin execution

Note: WD is defined as Working Days, which are Mondays through Fridays, excluding Federal holidays.

RLOA Timeline

- Throughout the quarter, FP&A drives alignment with business needs through RLOA:
 - FBPs, with the functional leader(s), maintain a RLOA file of key incremental investments from the business
 - FBPs, with the functional leader(s), prioritize the RLOA and develop a recommendation following the below high-level timeline
- Week 1: Corporate FP&A kicks off RLOA and shares calendar with FBPs
- Week 2: Forecast pencils down
 - FBPs submit prioritized RLOA asks
 - Corporate FP&A provide forecast preview to FBPs
 - Corporate FP&A and VP of Finance review forecast and RLOA submissions to determine funding
- Week 3: CFO review RLOA proposal based on forecast vs. street consensus performance
 - FP&A reviews RLOA asks with TA to determine recruiting feasibility
 - Pre-tax forecast lock used for earnings call preparation (pending on RLOA changes in Week 4)
- CFO reviews RLOA proposal based on forecast vs. street consensus performance
- Week 4: At e-group meeting, CFO shares proposal for formal approval and inclusion into final forecast lock and investor guidance
 - After formal approvals, business, FP&A, and TA collaborate to execute on RLOA approved asks

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/adaptive-insights.md

General Information

Adaptive Insights, a Workday company, is a cloud-based corporate performance management platform. The GitLab FP&A team utilizes Adaptive Insights to plan, budget, and forecast GitLab's planning cycles.

Administration

Versioning

One of the most powerful features of Adaptive Insights is versioning. Administrators can create, edit, and lock versions of a plan.

GitLab Version Nomenclature

Each version of GitLab should specify the fiscal year and label of the plan / forecast. Below is a few examples of the nomenclature used at GitLab

- FY21 - 0 + 12 Plan
- FY21 - 1 + 11 Forecast
- FY 21 - 2 + 10 Forecast

Roles

There are currently five different roles within GitLab's Adaptive Insights instance

1. Administrative - full control of Adaptive Insights
1. Analysis - can access sheets, reports, dashboards, and process trackers. Analysis can also share reports and complete tasks using the process tracker.
1. IT Administrator - full control of Adaptive Insights with the exception to salary details
1. Report Only - same as Analysis but can upload files for reporting
1. Standard - full control of Adaptive Insights with the exception to edit, modify or change structure. Standard also does not have admin or integration access

Users

Within Adaptive, the administrator can assign a name, position, user name, home page, time zone, country, role, and level(s) for each user. The administrator can also reset the password, if needed, for the User. Users should use Okta to sign into Adaptive Insights but keep their password in One Password when assigned one.

If you need access to Adaptive Insights, please open an access request and assign to the code owner of this page.

Accounts

Assumptions

Revenue Model

In its current state, the revenue model sheet is a static sheet that users input data into to build bookings, ARR and revenue. The revenue model sheet has inputs that come from several sources and are documented below, along with the inputs that build the sheet.

- Bookings

Bookings data is built from a model that Sales Finance owns and is inputted into the model several times a month. The input of bookings data occurs during a reforecast or plan and when actuals are reconciled with the Sales Ops team.

- ARR

Each month on the fourth business day of the month, the Corporate Finance team records ending ARR for the month in closing. In turn, this becomes the beginning ARR amount for the month in progress. For example, if GitLab's ARR was \$1M at the end of month 1, then the beginning ARR would be \$1M at the beginning of month 2. The month in progress builds upon the beginning ARR amount and several other inputs to forecast ending ARR. Those inputs are 'New and Growth Booked Net ARR', 'Booking Timing Adjustments', and 'Trueups'. GitLab also includes an input that results in a deviation within the forecasted model. These inputs are the basis of GitLab's Booking to ARR to Revenue forecast walk

$$\text{Beginning ARR} + \text{New Booked Net ARR} + \text{Growth Booked Net ARR} + \text{Booking Timing Adjustments} + (-1\text{Trueups}) + \text{Deviation Amount} = \text{Exit ARR}$$

With the walk, GitLab can determine its Delta ARR value. Delta ARR is the difference between Exit ARR from the prior period and the Exit ARR from the current period.

$$\text{Exit ARR (Current Period)} - \text{Exit ARR (Prior Period)} = \text{Delta ARR}$$

- Revenue

GitLab's revenue forecast is comprised of several models, which are noted below.

- Professional Services model

This model is owned by Sales Finance and forecasted the expected recognized revenue GitLab expects to obtain during a time period for all of GitLab's Professional Services offerings. The result of the expected recognized revenue is fed into the Bookings to ARR to Revenue model and recorded under GL account 4002, 4010.

- GitLab.com model

This model is owned by R&D Finance and forecasted the expected recognized revenue GitLab expects to obtain during a time period for all of GitLab's SaaS offerings. The result of the expected recognized revenue is fed into the Bookings to ARR to Revenue model and recorded under GL account 4007.

- Bookings to ARR to Revenue model

The bookings to ARR to Revenue model compiles the Exit MRR (Exit ARR / 12) amount, GitLab.com amount, and Professional Services amount to forecast out the expected recurring revenue for a specific time period. GitLab backs out the gitlab.com amount (recorded in GL account 4007) to forecast subscriptions account GL account 4001. GitLab does this by taking (Exit MRR - GitLab.com MRR) which results in the amount for GL account 4001. In a majority of cases, Exit MRR should always be less than or equal to recognized revenue.

- Template

The revenue model template can be found by searching the title Bookings to ARR to Revenue Walk [Template] in Google Drive or reaching out to the Corporate FP&A partner. The template

puts together the build from Bookings to Revenue in a walk that is easily understandable and traceable.

Currencies

Allocation Rules

Sheets

Level Assigned Sheets

Balance Sheet

A balance sheet is a financial statement that reports a company's assets, liabilities and shareholders' equity at a specific point in time. GitLab's Balance sheet can be found by clicking Sheets and then Balance Sheet.

Income Statement

The income statement primarily focuses on the company's revenues and expenses during a particular period. GitLab's Income statement can be found by clicking Sheets and then Income Statement.

Cash Flow

A cash flow statement is a financial statement that provides aggregate data regarding all cash inflows a company receives from its ongoing operations and external investment sources. It also includes all cash outflows that pay for business activities and investments during a given period. GitLab's Cash Flow Statement can be found by clicking Sheets and then Cash Flow.

Active Personnel

Active Personnel is the active headcount by department and entity. GitLab's Active Personnel can be found by clicking Sheets and then Active Personnel.

It is recommended that historical headcount information and active headcount churn is uploaded into the Active Personnel sheets with an end date populated. This will ensure only active headcount information is included in the forecasts. Historical information will allow headcount related analysis to be conducted, such as past and future headcount ratio, growth by headcount type and ramping reps analysis.

Planned Personnel

Planned Personnel is the planned headcount by department and entity in a given time period. GitLab's Planned Personnel can be found by clicking Sheets and then Planned Personnel.

Program Spend

Program Spend focuses on the expenses of events, subscriptions, and other programs that will be spent in a given time period. Program Spend can be found by clicking Sheets and then Program

Spend.

In each forecast version, actuals for expenses from the previous period are recommended to be manually entered. Therefore, trends for each major vendor can be assessed and forecasts for future periods can be adjusted if necessary.

Expense Type

There are 4 Expense Types each with different calculations in Adaptive: (Column: EXPENSETYPE)

1. Prepaid One Time · This is a one time pre paid expense.
 1. Event start date drives when the expense will hit the Income Statement.
 1. Expense is spread based on the contracted amount divided by contracted months.
 1. This calculated expense drives the GL Account selected in the "GLEXPENSEACCOUNTS" column.
1. Prepaid Amortization · This is a prepaid amortization expense. This calculation takes into account:
 1. Event start date drives when the expense will hit the Income Statement.
 1. Expense is spread based on the contracted amount divided by contracted months
 1. This calculated expense drives the GL Account selected in the "GLEXPENSEACCOUNTS" column.
1. Chances of Renewal · based on a %.
 1. Start Month Uplift · Takes into account any uplift that is expected to occur during the initial contract period and factors this into the renewal months.
 1. Monthly Growth Factor- based on a % of uplift that is expected to occur on the Start Month Uplift. (This is based on month over month uplift)
1. Per User · This calculates a per user expense. This calculation takes into account:
 1. This calculated expense drives the GL Account selected in the "GLEXPENSEACCOUNTS" column.
 1. Per User Cost (Column)
 1. Number of users (entered in timespan) per month.
1. PeriodicExpense · This is a sporadic expense.
 1. This calculated expense drives the GL Account selected in the "GLEXPENSEACCOUNTS" column.
 1. Expense (entered in timespan) on any given month.

Travel & Entertainment

Travel & Entertainment are expense assumptions related to travel & entertainment on a dollar amount per headcount. Travel & Entertainment can be found by clicking Sheets and then Travel & Entertainment.

User Assigned Sheets

Global Assumptions

SUI Assumptions by State

Allocations

Salary Range

Personnel Benefits by Level

Balance Sheet Assumptions

Commissions %

Revenue Model

Integrations

NetSuite

Adaptive Loaders

Scheduling

Formulas

Reports

Report Structure

The below image shows the current report structure in Adaptive Insights. There are six main folders within the structure. The folders labeled Annual Reports, Monthly Reports, Quarterly Reports, and YTD Reports are considered production reports and should receive sign off from the VP, Finance before moving to one of these folders. Before a report is considered production ready, a user must start a report in the Sandbox Reports folder, then get approval by the VP, Finance before it can be moved into one of the production ready Reporting folders. Once sign off is approved, a user should ask an Adaptive Insights administrator to move the folder from Sandbox to the production ready folder.

- 1. Annual Reports - folder that houses annual reports
- 1. Implementation Requirements - folder that houses any requirements
- 1. Monthly Reports - folder that houses monthly reports
- 1. Quarterly Reports - folder that houses quarterly reports
- 1. Sandbox Reports - folder that houses work in progress reports and where reports are created before moving to production
- 1. YTD Reports - folder that houses year to date reports

Reports

Processing Headcount Movements

Below details the process to account for headcount movements in Adaptive based on the type of change that's occurred.

Net New Roles

Net new hire movements which increase GitLab's headcount and are not related to a team member leaving GitLab or transferring between departments.

1. On the Planned Personnel sheet, create a new row and enter in the role details for the net new position. Include an anticipated start date and enter the headcount name as "TBH".

Team Member Terminations

For headcount moves due to team members leaving GitLab.

1. When a team member leaves GitLab, in the Active Personnel sheet where the headcount record is located, enter the team members' last day into the "End Date" column. This will feed into the calculations within Adaptive so any costs associated with that headcount will cease once the end date surpasses.
1. If the role is to be backfilled, on the Planned Personnel sheet, create a new row and enter in the role details of the termed team member. Populate the "Hire Status" field with Backfill and ensure you have entered this into the same level (department) that the termed team member was in. For the headcount name, use "TBH-" + First Initial + Last Name (e.g. for Joe Bloggs backfill, "TBH-JBloggs") so it can be easily identified as the backfill role for that team member and assist with headcount management processes.

Promotions (same job family), salary increases, new hiring managers/etc

1. When a team member gets promoted into the same job family, has a salary change, a new hiring manager, etc., the new information is overwritten on the existing entry field for that headcount in the Active Personnel sheet. The intention is to keep the Active Personnel sheet list as concise as possible.
 - E.g. A Financial Analyst is promoted to a Senior Financial Analyst - overwrite the Job Title field with the new role name and update any other relevant fields.

Internal Transfer

For headcount moves when a team member is transferred between departments and the original position is to be backfilled - e.g. team member moves from Marketing to Sales, and Marketing wants to backfill that position.

1. On the Active Personnel sheet enter an end date on the original headcount record.
1. Stay on the Active Personnel sheet and create a new entry/row in the level which matches the department the team member is moving to, and enter the internal transfer headcount details.
1. In the Planned Personnel sheet, create a new row and populate the details of the original position. For the headcount name, use "TBH-" + First Initial + Last Name (e.g. for Joe Bloggs backfill, "TBH-JBloggs") so it can be easily identified as the backfill role for that team member and assist with headcount management processes.

Internal hire (no backfill)

For internal headcount moves when there is an unknown candidate and no new position - e.g. 1 Manager role promotion available to replace 1 of 3 Analysts roles - no visibility of who will

get promoted and the analyst position will not be backfilled. This process is required in order for the talent acquisition team to be able to create a record in Greenhouse using a GHP ID that will be generated from the placeholder entry.

1. On the Planned Personnel sheet, create an entry/row for the internal movement placeholder. Enter the headcount Name as "TBH", the Hire Status as "Placeholder" and ensure no salary information is included. This will ensure that the calculations do not flow into the Income Statement for this \$0 placeholder entry.

1. Once the successful team member has been identified, update their record - overwrite the job title, salary information etc. and then delete the internal movement TBH entry from the Planned Personnel sheet.

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/corporate-finance.md

Welcome to the Corporate FP&A team page!

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- The Corporate FP&A handbook focuses on the partnerships with various teams and the expectations, deliverables, and cadence.
- Please see the team FP&A page for our mission, objectives, and key processes.
- If you'd like to collaborate with Corporate FP&A, tag the @corp-finance-team group in the fpanda channel or the channel where your team directly collaborates with FP&A

Accounting Partnership

- The FP&A team and Accounting collaborate to set deadlines as part of our monthly and quarterly close process. This enables a timely close and delivery of key information to EVPs/department heads around variance, forecast, and/or guidance. For the monthly FP&A close timeline, refer [here](#)
- We collaborate in GitLab issues to align on the close timeline each quarter. An example of this is the Q1-FY23 Close Timeline found [here](#).
- Every two weeks on Thursday, Accounting & FP&A have a sync to connect on close dates. Further, this is a meeting to discuss open items, questions, and process improvements.
- During close, Accounting leads daily close meetings where the status of close and any open items are provided. Summaries are shared at Slack channel month-end-close-and-gl-team.
- FBPs obtain a report with open invoices/POs from the Accounting team which is updated daily. The FBPs drive obtaining the required approvals and invoices from their respective business partners. Specific questions on entries are shared directly in the fpa-ap-gl-collaboration Slack channel to increase transparency between FP&A and AP/GL teams.

Tax Partnership

We collaborate with tax to review actual tax expenses, forecast tax provision for planning and guidance, and to understand the tax implications of future scenarios such as changes in tax laws or tax structure. We collaborate in the Slack channel tax-and-fpa

- Q1-FY23 example of timeline:
- 2022-05-06: Accounting closes books and consolidations occurs

- 2022-05-10: FP&A locks forecast and shares with Tax a full GAAP PTI forecast, including the forecasts for the non-GAAP entity-level P&L, stock-based compensation expense, and other GLs including depreciation, amortization, capital additions, etc.
- 2022-05-13: Tax shares preliminary quarterly tax provision forecast with FP&A
- 2022-05-16: Tax provision meeting with CFO, where Tax discusses a range of topics, including but not limited to: projected vs actual income tax expense and ETR, cash tax paid, tax attributes, tax reserves, and the final provision forecast. Corporate FP&A will use the final provision forecast communicated in this meeting in preparing the guidance.
- Notes:
 - Typically, FP&A will lock the forecast 48 hours after the books have closed. Tax will have at least 48 hours (2 days) to provide a preliminary provision forecast.
 - In the second month of each quarter, FP&A will share the latest locked forecast with Tax on Day 9 (or 48 hours after the books have closed, whichever is sooner) every month. Providing the latest forecast with Tax enables the team to update their tax models for the full year provision. The following is an example of such timeline for Month 2 of Q1-FY23 (using the 2+10 Forecast):
 - 2022-04-15: Accounting closes books and consolidations occurs
 - 2022-04-18: FP&A locks forecast and shares with Tax a full GAAP PTI forecast, including the forecasts for the non-GAAP entity-level P&L, stock-based compensation expense, and other GLs including depreciation, amortization, capital additions, etc.
- Close timelines can be found in GitLab Issues created by the Accounting team to increase transparency and efficiency across teams as part of close. The Q1-FY23 close timeline can be found at the issue [here](#).

Revenue Accounting Partnerships

- We collaborate with the Revenue team to review actuals as part of our revenue variance process performed each month and quarter-end, understand the impact on our revenue forecast as it relates to changes in the revenue waterfall, changes in the business, new accounting standards, or other process improvements.
- We meet each month to review actuals and collaborate in the Slack channel [revenue-and-fpa](#)

SEC reporting & Internal Audit Partnership

- We collaborate with SEC reporting & SOX compliance (SEC & SOX) teams to publish Quarterly and Annual Earning materials, and to ensure all materials are in compliance with SOX.
- We receive stock-based compensation (SBC) and Weighted Average Share Outstanding (WASO) information from the SEC team for SBC and WASO quarterly forecasts.
- We meet monthly to align expectations and discuss process issues and/or improvements.
- We use earnings^{call}comms and ^{fpas}ecreporting for collaboration & communications related to earnings materials.

Investor Relations Partnership

- We collaborate with the IR team to publish Quarterly and Annual Earning materials.
- We use earnings^{call}comms to collaborate & communicate.

Business Technology Partnership

- We support BT team for Adaptive/NetSuite integration to ensure data accuracy between two

systems and to meet compliance requirements. Integration is expected to be fully transitioned to the BT team by the end of Q2 FY23.

- We meet quarterly to align expectations & discuss transition plans. We use financesystemshelp for communications, and track requests & progress through GitLab issues.

Data and Analytics Partnership

- We work with the Data team to build out new dashboards and tables in Sisense as the SSOT for key metrics. Our collaboration ranges from creating different cuts of data significant to our business leaders to building out new connections between existing source data.

- For any new project or new question as it relates to an existing project, we open an issue with Data team and slack the data-gtm-projects channel to inform the team on a new issue.

- Business definitions around ATR, MYB, Billings, Prepaid vs not Prepaid and other formalized projects between the Data & Corporate FP&A team can be found here.

Talent & Total Rewards Partnership

- We collaborate with Total Rewards to align on budget and actuals for the Annual Compensation Review, promotions and benefits programs. We analyze scenarios in alignment with their team's strategic programs and benefits roadmap. We collaborate in the Slack channel fpa-total-rewards and have a weekly recurring meeting.

- More details on how the Compensation Program Budget is determined can be found in the total rewards handbook.

- As part of the annual planning process, FP&A helps to draft the next year's executive/director bonus plan structure as it relates to key performance metrics, payouts structure, acceleration milestones, etc. The Chief Financial Officer and the Chief People Officer will approve the bonus structure prior to Compensation Committee review. The deliverable for the Compensation Committee is a slide deck illustrating payment structure, milestone, and attainment various scenarios.

- We further collaborate with Total Rewards regarding in-year executive/director bonus attainment/payout. We provide Total Rewards with quarterly forecasts for estimated executive/director bonus in preparation for Compensation Committee meetings. The deliverable to the Total Rewards team is a summary slide(s) detailing attainment in each key metric.

- We assist Total Rewards with modeling for equity, including sizing equity pool sizes for the Employee Stock Purchase Plan and Equity Compensation.

- We collaborate regarding the above via the fpa-totalrewards Slack channel.

Key Processes

- Quarterly & Monthly Cycle (incl. close, variance, forecast, guidance)

- Plan

- Long Range Outlook

- Headcount

- Adaptive Insights

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/fpa-definitions.md

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/fpa-metrics.md

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/fpa-processes.md

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/ga-finance.md

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/gtm-analytics-hub.md

Common Links

- Sales Finance
- Sales Strategy & Analytics (SS&A)

Reports and Dashboards

File

<figure class="videocontainer">
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MXcJVe8yqVOireByQU9zGLSa3g1-nmz25ONG515QG6pt/pubhtml?widget=true&headers=false"></ifr
</figure>

SSOT Fields/Logic

- Order Type 2.0
- Stamped Opp Owner User (Segment/Region/Area)
- Sales Qualified Source
- DR - Partner Engagement Type
- DR - Partner
- Quote Start Date
- Filter: Closed Won + (Renewal Closed Lost)

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/headcount-metrics-and-processes.md

Public Company Headcount Metrics and Processes

Ending Headcount: As a public company, GitLab forecasts Ending Headcount on a monthly, quarterly, and annual basis. This metric is what headcount-related expenses and our investor guidance are based on, so it is mission-critical to get accurate. Underlined key terminology and a full list of terms are defined below.

Forecasted Ending Headcount is calculated as

1. Begin with Ending Headcount from previous period
1. Increase by: Gross Known Future Starts in period
1. Increase by: Gross Forecasted Future Starts in period
 - Gross Forecasted Future Starts include Offers Outstanding
1. Increase by: Attrition Backfills in period
 - Attrition Backfills are assumed not to be filled until the following quarter. As a result, the Ending Headcount is decreased in the current quarter due to Attrition. In all quarters following the current quarter, Attrition Backfills from the previous quarters are assumed to be filled, and the number of Attrition Backfill positions is equal to Attrition for the previous quarter.
1. Decrease by: Total Attrition applied to the previous quarter's ending headcount
 - Component 1 - Known Attrition: Remove any known attrites from prior period Ending Headcount
 - Component 2 - Forecasted Attrition: Using a 5% hypothetical quarterly attrition assumption for example purposes, back into the Forecasted Attrition assumption (e.g., if 3% is already Known Attrition, then adjust the Forecasted Attrition input to 2% to reflect the remaining portion expected to churn)
 - If attrition is more/less than expected in M1 and/or M2 of the quarter, the Forecasted Attrition Assumption is adjusted to solve back to the hypothetical 5% Total Attrition for the quarter
1. Decrease by: Internal Hires in period
1. Example · Q1 Ending Headcount · Q2 Ending Headcount:
 - 100 Q1 Ending Headcount
 - Increase by: 7 Gross Known Future Starts
 - Increase by: 14 Gross Forecasted Future Starts
 - Increase by: 0 Attrition Backfills (filled in following quarter)
 - Decrease by: 1 Known Attrites
 - Decrease by: 4 Forecasted Attrites (solve)
 - 100 Q1 Ending Headcount 5% hypothetical quarterly attrition = 5 Total Attrites
 - 5 Total Attrites - 1 Known Attrite = 4 Forecasted Attrites
 - = 114 Q2 Ending Headcount

1. Each period, FP&A and TA will align on the Ending Headcount figure as part of the quarterly forecast lock.

Key terminology used in Ending Headcount Calculation

1. Total Starts: Team members who have started their employment, accepted an offer, or are expected to start their employment within a specified period including Attrition Backfills.
 - Total Starts = Actual Starts + Total Future Starts,where:

- $\text{Total Future Starts} = \text{Known Future Starts} + \text{Forecasted Future Starts}$.

- Total Net New Starts: Total Starts excluding Internal Hires.
- Total Gross Starts: Total Starts including Internal Hires.

Total Net New Starts is the largest variable component of the movement in the Ending Headcount forecast. In order to accurately forecast Ending Headcount, Total Net New Starts must be accurately estimated. At the beginning of the quarter, FP&A and TA work with business partners to set realistic expectations related to the number of Total Net New Starts in a quarter. Through the Triad Process as well as the Interlock Process between FP&A and TA, GitLab tracks the movement of estimated Total Net New Starts throughout the quarter to ensure understanding and implementation of the most up-to-date view of forecasted headcount-related expenses.

1. Actual Starts: Team members who have begun their employment at GitLab within a specified period including Attrition Backfills. These team members are included in the Active Personnel sheet in Adaptive.

- Net New Actual Starts: Starts excluding Internal Hires.
- Gross Actual Starts: Starts including Internal Hires.

1. Total Future Starts: Team members who have either accepted an offer or are expected to start their employment within a future specified period including Attrition Backfills.

- Total Future Starts = Known Future Starts + Forecasted Future Starts.
- Total Net New Future Starts: Total Starts excluding Internal Hires.
- Total Gross Future Starts: Total Starts including Internal Hires.

1. Known Future Starts: Team members who have accepted offers to start employment, but have not yet started, within a specified period including Attrition Backfills.

- Net New Known Future Starts: Known Starts excluding Internal Hires.
- Gross Known Future Starts: Known Starts including Internal Hires.

1. Forecasted Future Starts: Team members who are expected to begin day one of their employment at GitLab within a specified period but have not accepted an offer (i.e., must not be counted as a Known Future Start) including Attrition Backfills. Forecasted Future Starts includes Offers Outstanding.

- Net New Forecasted Future Starts: Future Starts excluding Internal Hires.
- Gross Forecasted Future Starts: Future Starts including Internal Hires.

1. Offers Outstanding: Candidates who have received, but not accepted, Offers with Start Dates within a specified period including Attrition Backfills.

- Net New Offers Outstanding: Offers Outstanding excluding Internal Hires.
- Gross Offers Outstanding: Offers Outstanding including Internal Hires.

1. Attrition Backfills: Roles previously occupied by a team member that GitLab plans to fill again (either via an external candidate or Internal Hire).

1. Attrition/Attrites: Team members who end their GitLab employment (i.e., not including Internal Hires) within a specified period.

- Known Attrition: Team members who have given notice of their employment termination within a specified period.

- Forecasted Attrition: Attrition related to team members expected to terminate employment within a specific period. Known attrition plus Forecasted Attrition adds to the full attrition assumption for the period.

1. Internal Hires: Team members who change roles within GitLab via promotion, lateral movement, etc. within a specified period. To be counted as Internal Hires (including via promotion), team members must accept an offer for an open Greenhouse requisition.

Appendix: Other Public Company Headcount Definitions

1. Adaptive: FP&A's SSOT for all forecasted headcount metrics and headcount-related expenses. Adaptive is maintained by the FP&A team and roles are input into Adaptive by the FP&A team.

1. Start Date: Day one of a team member's employment at GitLab. Start Dates are estimated by FP&A based on the priorities of the business, target Start Dates information in Greenhouse, and collaboration with TA. Once a team member has started their employment, Workday is the SSOT for the official Start Date.

1. Net New Roles: New roles (i.e., not Attrition Backfills) that GitLab plans to (either via an external candidate or Internal Hire).

1. Offers: Employment offers extended to candidates within a specified period including Attrition Backfills.

- Offers are estimated based on Total Gross Starts within current and future periods. An average (based on analysis of historical data) of Offer to Start timing is applied to forecasted monthly Total Gross Starts in order to back into the estimated Offers needed to achieve the specified Total Gross Starts amount.

- Example of Offers estimate for November assuming straight-line Offer to Start timing

- Hypothetical November Total Gross Starts: 100

- Month0 Average November Total Gross Starts: $25\% \times 100 = 25$

- Month-1 Average October Total Gross Starts: $25\% \times 100 = 25$

- Month-2 Average September Total Gross Starts: $25\% \times 100 = 25$

- Month-3 Average August Total Gross Starts: $25\% \times 100 = 25$

- = 100 Total Offers in preceding four months needed to achieve November Total Gross Starts

1. Planned Personnel Sheet: The Planned Personnel Sheet is housed in Adaptive and reflects Gross Future Starts (i.e., includes roles that will eventually be filled via Internal Hires).

Appendix: Other Talent Acquisition Headcount Definitions

1. Greenhouse: SSOT for recruiting metrics and pipeline development in various stages of recruiting.

1. Workday: SSOT for Actual Starts and Start Dates.

1. Hires: Team members who accept an employment offer within a specified period. The start date of the team members' employment is irrelevant. Hires includes Internal Hires.

1. Recruiting Capacity: The capacity of recruiters related to Hires within a specified period. Individual recruiter capacity does not relate to Starts; however, we can estimate the recruiting organization's broader capacity for Starts by looking at historical Hire to Start

data.

1. Offer Accept: The date on which a candidate signs the Offer and is transferred into Workday. This process ideally happens within 24 business hours of signing the Offer, but may be backdated to the date of signature as needed.

1. Time to Fill: The number of days from the date of requisition opening until the date the accepting candidate has accepted the Offer. Time to Fill does not consider Start Date.

1. Offer Accept to Start Date: The number of days from an accepted offer to Start Date.

1. Time to Start: The number of days from the date of requisition opening until the successful candidate's Start Date.

1. Time to Hire: The number of days between the candidate's application date and when the candidate is moved into the Hire stage.

For more information on Talent Acquisition metrics, visit the Talent Acquisition KPIs and Job Architecture page.

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/team-structure.md

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/r-and-d-finance/_index.md

Welcome to the R&D Finance Handbook!

{.h2}

Finance Business Partner Alignment

Ellen Boyd, Director, FP&A @eboyd1

| Division/Department | Name |

| ----- | --- |

| Engineering | Jess Smith (@JessSmith), Petra Foget (@pfoget) |

| Product & UX | Jess Smith (@JessSmith), Petra Foget (@pfoget) |

| Security | Petra Foget (@pfoget) |

| Hosting | Matt Dunleavy (@mdunleavy), Pranoti Thote (@pthote) |

| Customer Support | Pranoti Thote (@pthote) |

@eboyd1 can approve Coupa and Greenhouse Reqs as needed for Finance Business Partners.

Common Links

- Financial Planning & Analysis (FP&A)

- Finance Issue Tracker

SECTION: finance/financial-planning-and-analysis/r-and-d-finance/hosting-main.md

GCP - Committed Use Discount (CUD) Process

See the page GCP CUD page of the handbook for a full write-up of the GCP CUD process.

Please submit a Finance issue using the CUD template to request a CUD purchase and assign to Matt Dunleavy.

AWS - Savings Plan (SP) and Reserved Instance (RI) Processes

Note: This page needs to be created

See the AWS Savings Plan page of the handbook for a full write-up on the AWS Savings Plan process.

Note: This page needs to be created

See the AWS Reserved Instances page of the handbook for a full write-up on the AWS Reserved Instance process.

Please submit a Finance issue using the appropriate template (AWS Savings Plan or AWS Reserved Instance) to request a purchase and assign to Matt Dunleavy.

SECTION: finance/growth-and-development/_index.md

Welcome to the GitLab Finance Growth and Development Page
{.h2}

The GitLab Finance Department is dedicated to the growth and development of our team members. To ensure that this is a focus area, we have come up with five programs for FY22.

On-Boarding Growth and Development

Finance Team Member on-boarding will include specific tasks and information to foster a culture of continued development. This will include:

- a list of "Must Meet" for onboarding coffee chats, to be provided by the team member's manager
- a working style assessment using Simpli5
- a view into the Finance Career Ladders and a view of the Org Chart
- a link to read GitLab's take on Career Development
- an overview of the mentorship programs, shadowing opportunities and internship programs
- links to the GitLab training tools available from the People group :External Resources (with no cost) & Internal Resources

Work Style Assessment

We will use Simpli5 assessments to help us develop a standardized set of terms for us to all communicate more efficiently. Simpli5 gives you the power to understand YOUR natural tendencies

as well as the natural tendencies of your co-workers. This awareness will help you gain a new perspective of yourself and your teammates.

Career Plans and Growth Ladders

Every individual is ultimately responsible for their career plan and managers are responsible for providing an environment to develop a plan. We will work on a structure that clearly lays out a career plan progression and tools to communicate a plan by aligning to the GitLab Career Development handbook page.

Cross Training, Mentorship and Shadow Programs

To align with career development plans, we will create opportunities for cross training with other team members. This will not only allow for knowledge transfer for growth, it will also allow leadership opportunities for team members that wish to train.

With the success of several mentorship programs at GitLab, we will create a similar program for the Finance Org.

We will create opportunities to shadow finance leaders for team members to gain perspective and business acumen.

CFO Shadow Program

In FY23Q1, we are implementing a CFO Shadow Program which will initially be available to Finance Division team members. The CFO Shadow Program will be modeled off of the CEO Shadow Program which has proven to be a differentiated and impactful development opportunity for GitLab team members. The goal of the CFO Shadow Program is to extend that opportunity to team members with an interest and background in Business and/or Finance who are interested in learning more about what it means to be a CFO at a publicly traded company. The exposure from this experience is intended to support both the long and short term career development of the shadow.

The CFO Shadow Program is a rotation that runs over the course of 2 weeks, with the shadow attending meetings with the CFO for 3 days per week (Tuesday - Thursday) during each week (aligned with EST). More information about the program logistics can be found in our CFO Shadow Program page

Training Aligned to GitLab L&D

Together with GitLab L&D, we created the Finance Learning Hub, a curated learning channel in Level Up.

To align and support the broader GitLab L&D efforts, we will promote the training made available by the People team. This will allow us to give back and contribute in a way that makes this program even stronger. We will continue to look for ways to create a curriculum that fits the different areas of the finance org.

SECTION: finance/growth-and-development/career-growth.md

Welcome to Learning and Development for the Finance Department at GitLab! The resources in this page are meant to support team members by providing consistent frameworks through which to evaluate their career and role growth. This page compiles content that is both GitLab-generic and finance-specific as listed below.

GitLab General

Competencies

- GitLab approach to competencies
- GitLab scope and behaviors by level
- GitLab values competencies
- GitLab remote work competencies
- GitLab manager competencies

Career Resources

- Career development at GitLab
- GitLab promotions and transfers
- Performance / Potential Matrix

Finance Specific: Job Families & Competencies by Level (WIP)

Accounting

- Accountant
- Accounting and External Reporting
- Accounting Operations
- Accounts Payable
- Accounts Receivable
- Billing
- Corporate Controller
- GL Accounting
- Internal Audit
- Payroll
- Revenue Accounting
- Stock Administration
- Technical Accounting
- Principal Accounting Officer

Tax

- International Tax Manager
- Director of Tax

FP&A

- FP&A

- Data and Analytics
- VP Finance

Data and Analytics

- Data Engineer
- Data Analyst
- Data Scientist
- Data Manager

Procurement

- Procurement Operations

Enterprise Applications

- Business System Analyst
- Finance Systems Administrator
- Integrations Engineer
- Sr. Dir. Enterprise Applications
- VP IT

IT

- IT Compliance
- IT Helpdesk Analyst
- IT Operations System Engineer
- IT Systems Engineer
- IT Manager

SECTION: finance/growth-and-development/cfo-shadow-program.md

Overview

The CFO Shadow Program is an immersive 1 or 2 week assignment where team members can apply to shadow the CFO. The 70:20:10 model for learning shows us that most adults gain ~90% of their knowledge through experiential learning. While formal "classroom" style training plays an important role in teaching new concepts, real life experiences are critical to helping adults develop and retain new skills. The CFO Shadow program is a unique growth opportunity for team members who are looking to experience a "day in the life" of a CFO of a publicly traded company, gain greater cross-functional insight, and develop their general business and Finance acumen.

In the spirit of boring solutions, the CFO Shadow program mirrors the original CEO Shadow program in many ways, with some customizations.

What to Expect

The CFO Shadow program consists of a 1 or 2 week rotation, depending on the CFO's availability, where the shadow attends nearly all meetings with the CFO on Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday typically. If 2 consecutive weeks are available, the CFO shadow can apply to be scheduled for both weeks. Meetings are all-remote, so the program does not require travel, and meetings are conducted in regular business hours in Eastern Standard Time. Shadows should work with their managers to treat the Tues-Thurs of both weeks that they are participating in the program as time away from their day-to-day role so that they are able to focus primarily on the CFO Shadow experience. The days are commonly meeting heavy, so it's useful to plan to use any time at the end of the day to process what you learned, catch up on notes, or complete any small tasks assigned by the CFO.

Eligibility

The CFO shadow program is open to all team members.

To benefit the most from the types of meetings that the CFO attends, it's recommended that the participants have a general understanding of Finance, Business, Economics, and/or Accounting principles. CFO Shadows must be in good performance standing in their current role.

How to Apply

1. Create a merge request to add yourself to the rotation schedule
1. Assign your manager and ask them to approve (but not to merge) the merge request
1. Once your manager approves the merge request, assign the merge request to the Sr EBA to the CFO

Additional Preparation

Confidentiality

Participating in the shadow program is a privilege where you will be exposed to confidential information. This is underpinned by trust in the shadows to honor the confidentiality of topics being discussed and information shared. The continuation of this program is entirely dependent on shadows past, present, and future honoring this trust placed in them. Please be aware that the role of CFO Shadow will place you on the Designated Insider list for that quarter. You will need to request pre-clearance to trade during the open window. More info on the Designated Insider list and pre-clearance can be found [here](#).

Create an onboarding and offboarding issue

We currently track onboarding and offboarding in the cfo-shadow project. For questions, reach out to the Staff EBA to the CFO in the cfo-shadow channel

At this time, we do not have a "See One, Teach One" rotational rhythm in place, but as a CFO shadow you should be prepared to be a buddy to the following quarter's shadow as described in the onboarding issue.

Consider adding goals

Develop goals for your time as a CFO Shadow and add them to your onboarding issue. To make your

goals more actionable, you may want to use the SMART goals framework.

Practice your introduction

It's important that you represent yourself correctly when joining meetings, both internally and externally. You can introduce yourself by stating your name, your normal title, and then by stating that you are in the CFO Shadow Program. The stated purpose should be to give participants an overview of the finance function at GitLab. You will update your Zoom name to include "CFO-Shadow" to provide clarity for why you are joining calls.

It will be helpful to read more about introductions related to the CEO Shadow Program [here](#)

Review the CFO's calendar

Schedule a call with the CFO's Staff EBA to the CFO to review the CFO's calendar to get an idea of what your upcoming days will be like.

During the Program

During the program, you will gain valuable context from a variety of conversations that you'll be part of.

There will be short-term administrative tasks that you'll be asked to perform as the shadow.

1. Handbook updates

1. Prepare for, take notes during, and follow up on meetings and action items

Meetings

1. The CFO's Staff Executive Business Administrator will add you to all meetings that you can attend. There will be some meetings and events the shadows do not attend. Do not feel obligated to attend every meeting · all meetings are considered optional.

1. As a reminder, you should have your title updated within your last name on Zoom. During the Shadow rotation update your title to "CFO Shadow". Here is the [how to update your title](#) as part of your last name to ensure it shows up on zoom.

1. Meetings with those outside of GitLab may not be on Zoom. Prior to the call, check the CFO's calendar and load any other conferencing programs that may be needed. It may be necessary to dial in via phone for audio-conferences. If you have any problems confirming the link, reach out to the [cfo-shadow slack channel](#).

Other Notes on Meetings

- Like all meetings at GitLab, meetings will begin promptly, regardless of the shadows' attendance.
- The CFO's Staff EBA will ask external people if they are comfortable with the shadows joining prior to the scheduled meeting, and will share a link to the CFO shadow page to provide context.
- Meeting agendas should be shared with cfo-shadow@gitlab.com, as shadows will be added to this email alias prior to the rotation, and removed at the conclusion of it. For agendas that contain sensitive information, the sensitive information should be removed and the document

shared with "View only" access to restrict access to the document's history. Not all agendas will be shared, though, and the CFO Shadows should feel empowered to ask for access if that is the case. Sometimes, the answer will be "no" for sensitive reasons.

- There will be times where the Shadow will not attend meetings because a participant in the meeting is uncomfortable or prefers more privacy.

Shadows will be invited to join most 1:1's as an observer. You will not receive access to these agenda docs. If there are confidential matters to discuss, the shadow will be asked to drop off the Zoom near the end of the call for private discussion.

Shadow's Responsibilities During Meetings

Meetings come in many different formats. Your responsibilities may change slightly based on the kind of meeting.

Here are the responsibilities shadows have during meetings:

Meeting type	Notes?	Timekeeping?	
-----	-----	-----	
1-1	No notes	No timekeeping unless requested	
1-1 meetings with a GitLab Board Member	No notes	Timekeeping	
Internal meeting (CFO not host)	Notes optional	Timekeeping	
Investor Calls	No notes	Timekeeping	
Anything else (unless specified)	Notes	Timekeeping	

Keeping time

Shadows are responsible for being aware of the current time and verbally providing timekeeping or via Zoom chat in many types of meetings. This allows participants to comfortably wrap up the meeting.

Tips for time-keeping:

- Understand meeting length. Use the calendar invite as an indication of how long the meeting should last. Remember, we do speedy meetings.
- Shadows should provide a 5-minute and a 1-minute notification. You can write "Time check, 5 minutes" on Zoom chat.
- If a meeting is running over the allocated time, unmute and verbally say "we're in overtime". Don't wait for a break in the conversation.

Tools to help.

You can use this shell script (MacOS only) to run a timer for the desired number of minutes. The script will notify you 5 minutes before the end of the meeting, and will copy "We have five minutes left" to your clipboard, so you can paste the text directly in the Zoom chat in addition to verbalizing it. At the end of the meeting, the same will occur with "We are at time".

To use the script:

1. Download setalarm, making sure to preserve the .sh extension. (recommended within your Home folder for easy access)

1. Load MacOS Terminal by running Cmd+Space and typing terminal.
1. Run source setalarm.sh to load the setalarm function into memory.
1. Then simply type setalarm 50 to set a 50-minute timer (setalarm defaults to 25 minutes if no argument is provided).

Press Ctrl+C if you need to cancel the alarm. You may keep the terminal window running indefinitely so that it is at your finger tips throughout your program duration.

Rotation Schedule

Finance team members have a high workload and may not be able to complete a full 3-day rotation. If you are interested in shadowing for the full or part of the weeks listed below, open the MR to add your name to schedule per the instructions on How to Apply, and message the slack channel cfo-shadow with the exact dates you are requesting.

Start Date	End Date	Shadow Name
--- ----- -----		
Tuesday 2025-01-21	Thursday 2025-01-23	Stacy Cline
Tuesday 2025-03-18	Thursday 2025-03-20	Vikas Agrawal
Tuesday 2025-03-25	Thursday 2025-03-27	Available

SECTION: finance/growth-and-development/finbt-mentorship.md

FinBT Mentorship at GitLab
{.h1}

Mentorship is an opportunity to learn from personal experience, background, and perspective. Mentorship builds trust, provides a safe space to make mistakes, and encourages growth for both the mentor and mentee.

Starting in Q1FY24 the FinBT Department will pilot a limited mentorship program for FinBT Team Members. The purpose in having a specific mentorship program for FinBT is to provide opportunities for Team Members to get mentorship to develop the specific skills that are important for members of this team and will provide opportunities for career development and networking.

Why consider Department Level Mentorship?

Both department-level and company-wide mentorship programs have their own unique benefits.

Department Level Mentorship program

1. Targeted support: Mentees receive targeted support and guidance from a mentor who is familiar with the specific challenges and opportunities within their department or team.
1. Building team cohesion: A department-level mentorship program can foster a sense of team cohesion and collaboration, as mentees and mentors work together to achieve departmental goals.
1. Promoting best practices: A department-level mentorship program can promote the sharing of best practices within a department, improving overall performance and productivity.

1. Developing departmental leadership: Mentees can develop leadership skills within their specific department, which can help drive growth and development within the team.

Company-wide Mentorship program

1. Exposure to different perspectives: A company-wide mentorship program can expose mentees to different perspectives and experiences from mentors in different departments or areas of the company.

1. Networking opportunities: A company-wide mentorship program can provide mentees with opportunities to expand their professional network beyond their own department.

1. Cross-functional collaboration: A company-wide mentorship program can facilitate cross-functional collaboration and innovation by promoting communication and sharing of ideas across different parts of the company.

1. Talent development: A company-wide mentorship program can help develop a pipeline of talent across the organization, identifying and developing potential leaders and high-performers.

Benefits and Expectations

Benefits for the mentee

- 1. Be encouraged to prioritize, and be held accountable for, your career development
- 1. Learn new skills related to your current role, your future career goals, or an area that you're passionate about
- 1. Set and reach clearly outlined goals.

Benefits for the mentor

- 1. Serve as a leader in the organization by enabling growth for other team members
- 1. Practice leadership, effective communication, and coaching skills
- 1. Establish yourself as an expert in a field or specialty
- 1. Build trust with team members

Expectations

| Expectation | Description |

| ----- | ----- |

| Mentees lead conversations | Mentorship is led by the mentee, similar to how 1:1's at GitLab are driven by direct reports. |

| Maintain Boundaries | Maintain clear and appropriate boundaries. Be clear on your responsibilities and those of their manager. |

| Set Goals | Mentees should create goals, put them in writing, and frequently revisit goals to measure progress. |

| Build Trust | Colleague first, expert second. Spend time getting to know one another. Be open, honest, and fully authentic. |

| Set Expectations | Be realistic and uphold your commitment. Share access to resources and people, but make it clear you do not wield your influence over others. |

| Listen | Establish trust and openness in communication. Give your full, undivided attention. Hear concerns before offering advice and guidance. |

| Acknowledge Independence | Recognize mentee goals and autonomy. Your role as a mentor is to guide; it's up to the mentee to decide what to implement in their own career. |

- | Respect Diverse Experiences | Recognise that underrepresented groups might face additional barriers to advancement. Educate yourself and ask for advice and support via the appropriate DIB channels. |
- | Practice Self-Awareness | Identify your strengths, weaknesses, and biases. Be aware of and respect other's experiences, ideas, and goals. |
- | Advocate | Mentor others on being effective managers or colleagues to those who might have different experiences to them. Teach your mentee how to become a mentor themselves · by example and by encouragement.|
- | Express Gratitude | Share openly about your experience. Express gratitude for the skills or experiences developed over time. |
- | Maintain a Growth Mindset | Practice a growth mindset. Both parties can learn and grow from mentorship |
- | Iterate | Iterate on goals throughout the mentorship. Focus on quick wins that the mentee can reach, then keep growing. |
- | Confidentiality | Respect the trust built between mentor and mentee. Challenges and conversations shared in mentorship sessions should be kept confidential unless the mentor and mentee are okay with them being shared. |

Adapted from the NCWIT Mentoring-in-a-Box Mentoring Basics - A Mentor's Guide to Success, section What Are the "Dos" of Mentoring and People Grove resources

Participating in the Pilot Program

TBD

Resources

Resources below are designed to guide mentor/mentee relationships in both synchronous and asynchronous formats. Adopt what fits and leave what doesn't.

Mentor and Mentee training

Take the LinkedIn Learning training called How to be a Good Mentor and Mentee. It covers strategies for finding a mentor, setting clear expectations, and achieving goals through mentorship. Content from this training has been adapted in the following Google Slides presentation for learners who prefer to read the material at their own pace.

```
<iframe
src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/e/2PACX-1vS3cZJcClvs44OfN9QLjje2wRqS7EwnrK3HCSZeT
ZGwk58hPq17L-cDvCdvu0jxjR3r6yY8xY79/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=60000" frameborder="
width="960" height="569" allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true"
webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
```

Mentee: What to do before your mentor